Season 2: The Beast and the Betrayal

Attack on Titan - Detailed Season Summary (Episodes 26-37)

Season: 2 | **Episodes:** 12 (series episodes 26-37) | **Original run:** April - June 2017

Story arcs: Titans inside Wall Rose, Ragako Village, Siege of Utgard Castle, Reiner and Bertholdt reveal themselves, Ymir and Historia

Key characters: Eren Yeager, Reiner Braun, Bertholdt Hoover, Ymir, Historia Reiss (Krista Lenz), Connie Springer, Beast Titan

Spoiler warning: this document summarises the anime in full, including major twists and the ending of the season described.

1. Season Overview

Season 2 continues directly after the capture of the Female Titan in Stohess District. It is a shorter season that is largely focused on the 104th Training Corps and the personal histories of its members. Titans begin appearing inside Wall Rose even though its gates were never breached, which forces the Survey Corps and the cadets to find out how this is possible. The season's major themes are betrayal, loyalty and the discovery that the people closest to the heroes are hiding enormous secrets. It ends with the revelation of two more Titan shifters, the introduction of a new and mysterious Beast Titan, and the departure of one of the most important characters in the cadet group.

2. Major Characters in Season 2

Eren Yeager struggles to control his Titan power while the world around him becomes more uncertain. **Mikasa Ackerman** and **Armin Arlert** continue to support him. **Reiner Braun** and **Bertholdt Hoover** are revealed as the Armored and Colossal Titans. **Ymir** and **Krista Lenz** (later revealed as **Historia Reiss**) are central to the emotional core of the season. **Connie Springer** and **Sasha Braus** face the destruction of their home villages. **Jean Kirstein** and the other cadets fight in the major battles. **Levi Ackerman**, **Hange Zoe** and **Erwin Smith** lead the Survey Corps. Veteran Survey Corps soldiers such as **Nanaba, Gelgar, Henning and Lynne** defend Utgard Castle. **Pastor Nick**, a member of the Wall Cult, hints at hidden knowledge about the origin of the walls. The **Beast Titan** appears as a new and highly intelligent enemy that can command ordinary Titans.

3. Detailed Plot Summary

Arc 1 - Aftermath and Titans Inside Wall Rose

Following the battle in Stohess, the Survey Corps studies the aftermath. Hange attempts to interrogate Pastor Nick of the Wall Cult, who knows more about the origins of the walls than he lets on, but he refuses to say anything. Meanwhile Annie remains sealed in her crystal and cannot be forced out. Soon after, Titans appear within Wall Rose, though no gate or wall has been broken. Nobody understands how they got there, and the cadets are sent to investigate.

Arc 2 - Ragako Village

While travelling, Connie, Sasha and their companions visit Ragako, Connie's home village. They find the village in ruins, with dormant Titans lying among the wreckage. In a haunting scene, a Titan resting on top of Connie's collapsed house seems to greet him as he leaves, which strongly suggests that the Titans may

have once been humans, and perhaps even Connie's own family. The Survey Corps starts to reconsider everything it believed about the origins of Titans.

Arc 3 - The Siege of Utgard Castle

A group of cadets, including Reiner, Bertholdt, Ymir, Krista and Connie, retreat to Utgard Castle, an old fortress on the wall, along with several Survey Corps veterans. At night, Titans (which are normally inactive after dark) swarm the castle. A new enemy, a huge ape-like Titan covered in fur, hurls boulders from far away and kills horses and soldiers. This is the Beast Titan, and it appears to command the other Titans. Without their 3D Maneuver Gear, the cadets face a long night. During the siege, Reiner remembers a traumatic moment from his past. Ymir, who has hidden her secret for years, finally jumps from the tower and transforms into a Titan to save everyone, revealing that she is a shifter who can change at will. Her transformation is the first sign that more people with Titan powers exist than anyone thought.

Arc 4 - Reiner and Bertholdt Reveal Themselves

After the survivors return, Reiner takes Eren aside and, in a surprisingly casual conversation, tells him that he is the Armored Titan and that Bertholdt is the Colossal Titan. He explains that five years earlier they breached Wall Maria in order to destroy humanity. Eren is stunned and furious. Reiner asks him to come with them voluntarily, but Eren refuses, and a battle breaks out. Reiner and Bertholdt transform; Eren fights as a Titan while Mikasa and others attack. The Colossal Titan's steam prevents the soldiers from approaching. The two Warriors capture Eren and Ymir and flee toward the wall.

Arc 5 - The Chase and Ymir's Choice

The Survey Corps pursues the enemy through the Forest of Giant Trees. In the forest, Ymir refuses to cooperate with Reiner and Bertholdt unless they promise to take Krista with them. She sees similarities between Krista's lonely past and her own life. As the pursuing soldiers close in, Eren, in a moment of intense emotion, unleashes a mysterious power that makes other Titans swarm and attack a particular Titan: the one that ate his mother. The Titan is torn apart and the others chase the Warriors away. Hannes, who was eaten by that Titan earlier, is lost. Eren's power over Titans is unexplained, but it shows that his abilities go beyond transforming.

Arc 6 - Historia and the Aftermath

Ymir ultimately says goodbye to Krista and leaves with Reiner and Bertholdt rather than return to the walls. Krista, who had spent years trying to please everyone, resolves to live honestly and to embrace her real name, Historia. The season closes with the Survey Corps returning to the walls, knowing that the enemy is stronger than expected and that the history behind the walls is far more complicated than they believed. Historia's true family background sets up the political arc of Season 3.

4. Key Revelations of Season 2

(1) Reiner Braun is the Armored Titan and Bertholdt Hoover is the Colossal Titan, and they were the ones who breached Wall Maria. (2) Ymir is also a Titan shifter, with the ability to transform at will. (3) The Beast Titan exists, can command lesser Titans and is allied with the enemy shifters. (4) By the end of the season the Survey Corps understands that Titans, including those in villages like Ragako, are transformed humans. (5) Eren has a hidden power that allows him to influence Titans. (6) Krista Lenz is an alias; her real name is Historia, and her family background will prove important.

5. How the Story Progresses

Season 2 shifts the focus from large-scale battles to character-driven storytelling. The tension builds slowly through the investigation of Titans inside Wall Rose, then explodes at Utgard with the Beast Titan's attack, Ymir's transformation and the unmasking of Reiner and Bertholdt. The season shows that the soldiers' enemies are people with feelings, pasts and doubts, and that not every betrayal is simple. By the end, the humans know the identities of the Armored and Colossal Titans, but they do not know why those two acted as they did, where they came from or what the Beast Titan wants. The next season will explore the history of the walls and the royal family, and will lead the Survey Corps back to Shiganshina.